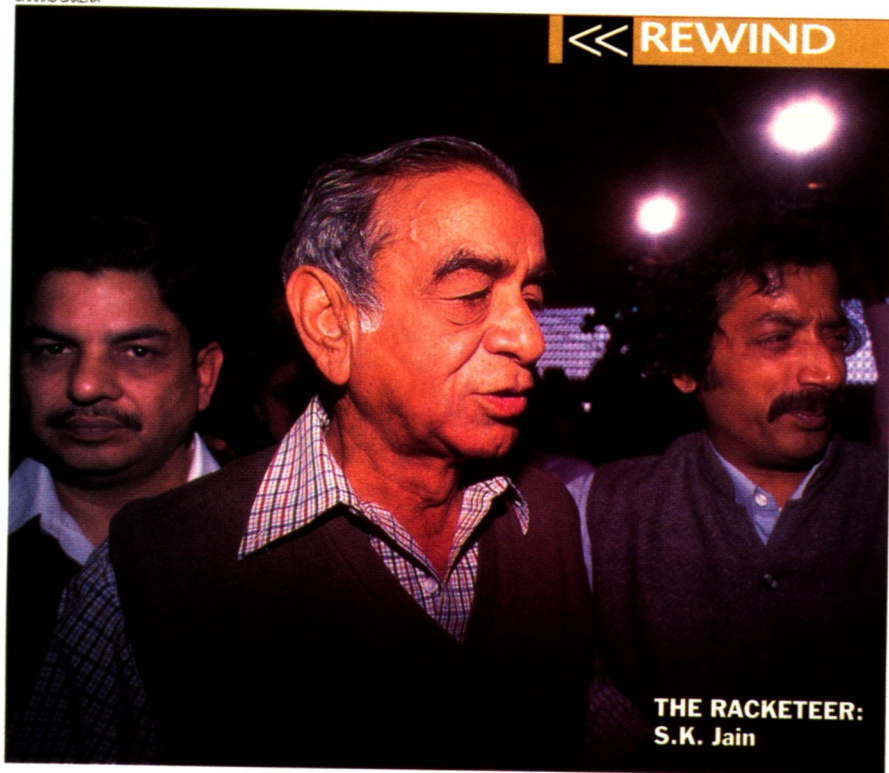


POWER GAMES

SHARAD SAXENA



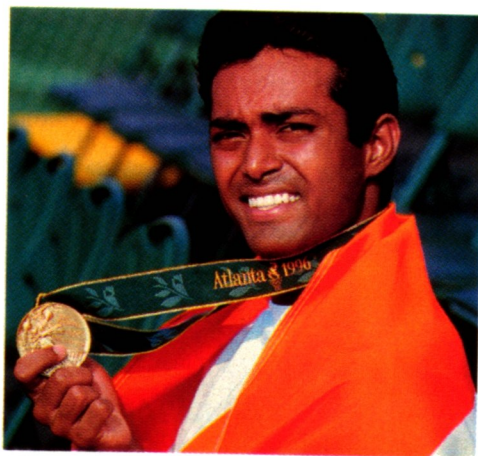
◀◀ REWIND

THE RACKETEER:
S.K. Jain

When the CBI, on January 16, sought permission to chargesheet top political leaders in the Jain Hawala case, it swept in its dragnet three Cabinet ministers of the Narasimha Rao Government—Balram Jakhar, V.C. Shukla and Madhavrao Scindia—as well as opposition leaders like L.K. Advani and Sharad Yadav. Hawala broker S.K. Jain's diaries revealed that over the years he had transacted with at least 115 persons, working as a middleman on deals for multinational power companies.

THE JHARKHAND TRAP

Former Jharkhand Mukti Morcha leader Shailendra Mahato filed a public interest litigation in Delhi alleging that P.V. Narasimha Rao, Satish Sharma, Buta Singh, Bhajan Lal and others had bribed JMM and breakaway Janata Dal leaders to vote in favour of the minority Congress government in the no-confidence motion it faced in 1993. The CBI looked into the matter in earnest only after Rao left office.



A LONG WAIT

Leander Paes brought India its first individual Olympic medal since 1948, winning the bronze medal at the Atlanta Olympics, beating Brazilian Fernando Meligeni.

FIRST CUT

- The BJP secured 160 seats in the Lok Sabha elections to emerge as the single largest party in the house.
- The first lung transplantation in

India was conducted at Chennai.

- The Krem Um Lawan, the longest (6,381 m) and deepest (106.8 m) cave in the Indian subcontinent, was discovered in Meghalaya by an Indo-German expedition.

◀◀ DID YOU KNOW

In the 1996 World Cup, held jointly by India, Pakistan and Sri Lanka, Anil Kumble was the highest wicket-taker (15 wickets) and Sachin Tendulkar the highest run scorer (523 runs).